

1. The fact that there are contingent things is contingent.
2. Every contingent fact has an explanation. (PSR)
3. The fact that there are contingent things has an explanation. (1,2)
4. The fact that there are contingent things can't be explained by any contingent thing.
5. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some thing which is not contingent. (3,4)
6. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some necessary thing. (5)
7. There is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things. (6)
8. If there is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things, then God exists.

C. God exists. (7,8)

THE COSMOLOGICAL ARGUMENT

We can again consider the hypotheses of simple theism and simple atheism, and now consider alongside them the quasi-theistic hypothesis that the universe was created by a being with the unusual property that it is literally impossible for that being not to exist.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



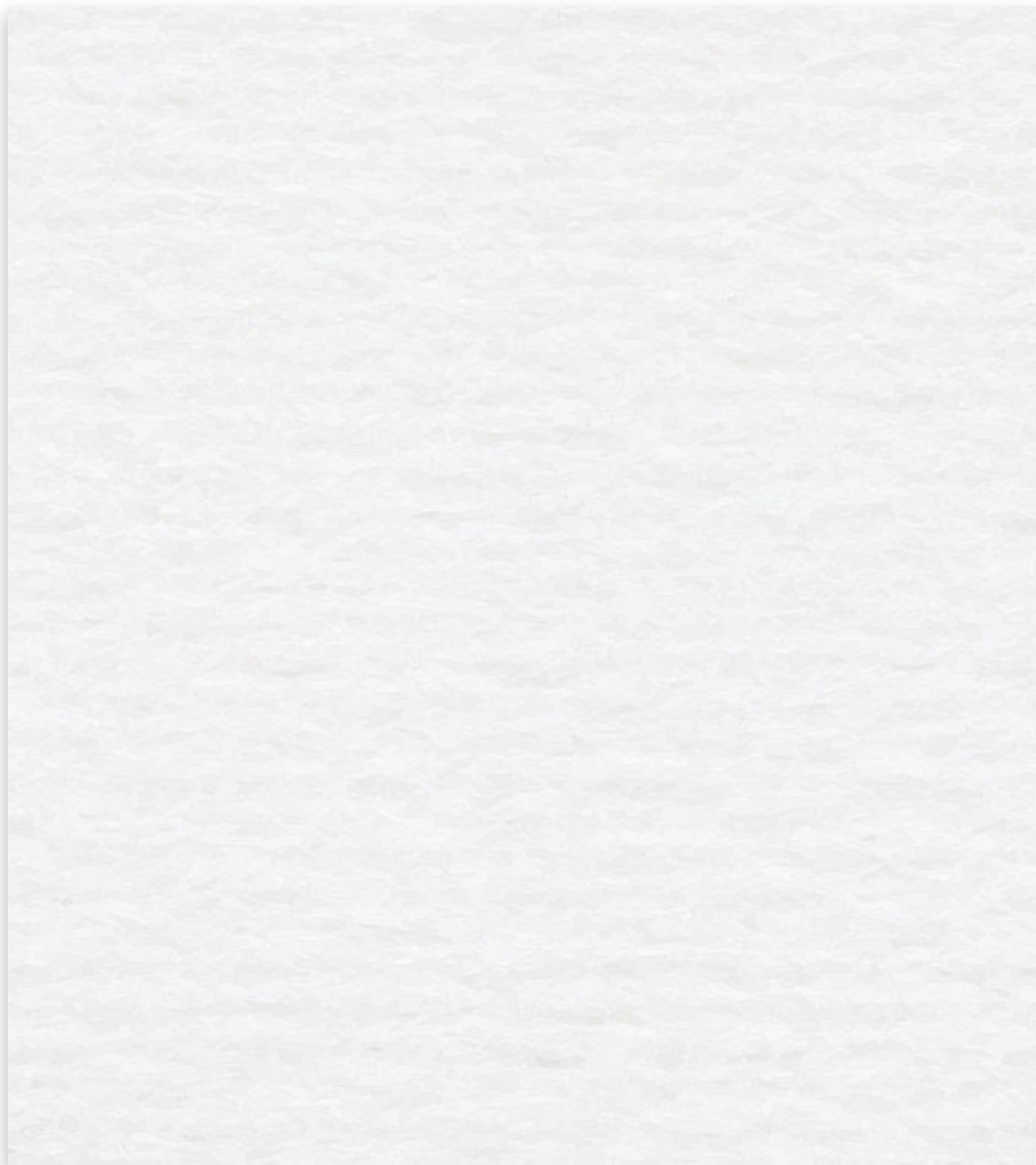
objections
to the
PSR

It is a point familiar from our discussion last time that one can always reply to an argument for the existence of God by opting for some form of quasi-theism. Such arguments are always arguments that a being with such-and-such special properties exists, and one can always concede that a being with the special properties exists, but deny that that being is God.

But, arguably, this move gets less and less plausible the more special the properties are, and the less likely it is, from an atheist's point of view, that a being with those properties would exist.

And so it is worth emphasizing that the property of existing necessarily is a very special property indeed. Everything around us seems to be contingent. A being whose existence is literally impossible would be fundamentally unlike any of the things that surround us.

It is a feature of many religious traditions that, in some sense or other, God's nature includes existence itself, and that nothing could exist without God. Leibniz's argument — if it is sound — seems to show that a being with these surprising properties exists.



there are





artist

1

2

3

4

contingent



al

l

o

things



contingent.

exp1aati01n.

is it

12

3

5

Every

Inde



20

Inde

i

a

c

u

theire

3



(1, 2)

(PSR)



earr

all

do

es

3

1

0



12345

contingent

aiy

3

1

0

the rise

by

things



5



b

y

exp1aati.in.

thinking.







thinning



is it

contingent

T

in

e

things

T

in

e

S

O

III

E

(3,4)



windic

contingent.







underline

expended

is at





by

thinings

S

O

III

E





There is





thinning.





things.





t

in

e

thinning



windic

enstaircase







u

du

e

re

e



thinning





exp1airis

t

in

e

wind

exilis + stercor





exilis est.

(7,8)

things,



the in

G

O

d

exilis + d.



God



we

C

G

n

again

consider

the

hypotheses



simple

and

simple

thine is n

atheneism,

and

n

o

w

consider

alongside

the

then

theistic

created

hypothesis

that

was

university

the

by

with

the

unusuli

that

being







impossible

literally

quasi-

that



n

o

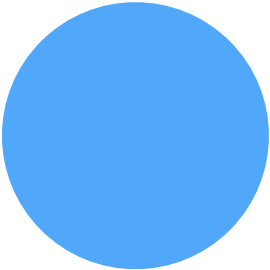
t

being

exis^t.₀

for

property





the
PSR



reply

time







point

faniriara

from



1

ast

sonne

argument





arguments

discussion

C

E

N

a | ways

a | ways

that

thre



existence

for

by



for

God

a | ways

opting

such





quasi-theism.

arguments

that

properties



with



such-and-such

exists,

and

but

for n

C

S

R



concealed



that

being

exists,

properties



that

being

Special

deny

Special

with

that

God.

being

the

are!



arguably,

les

es

es

es

Special

and

les

es

es

es

But,

and

that

plausible

the

thnose

properties



Hikey

properties

from

gets

would



this is

at herists'

thre



no

o

r

e

no

o

v

e



view

view

view

view



with

les

es

es

es

the

point



being

exis^t.²



And

the



Everything

indexed.

verv

property



worlth

SEMINES

necessarily

any



emph·asizing

would



existing

property

Special

that

things

U

S



be

fundamentally



be

existence

continuent.

being

the

literally





U

S



who see



unlike

that

around

impossible

surround

many

nature

seren



nothing

exist

traditions



that

SONE

and





feature



God's

other,

that,





existence



argument

Leibniz's

God.



Sound

withnout



could

religious





includes



itsself,

show

SEEMS





surprising

with

properties

being

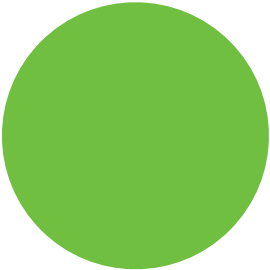
exists.

these

that







... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



Leibniz's
argument



objections
to the
PSR









W









simply



we

considered

objection

Aquinas'

assumption

first

A pixelated, grayscale uppercase letter 'C'. The letter is composed of dark gray pixels with lighter gray shading to create a 3D effect, particularly on the right side where the curve ends.A pixelated, grayscale uppercase letter 'B'. The letter has a thick, blocky appearance with dark gray pixels and lighter gray shading to give it a three-dimensional look.A pixelated, grayscale uppercase letter 'W'. The letter is formed by dark gray pixels with lighter gray shading to create a 3D effect, especially on the vertical strokes and the bottom curve.A pixelated, grayscale uppercase letter 'E'. The letter is composed of dark gray pixels with lighter gray shading to create a 3D effect, particularly on the right side of the horizontal bars.A pixelated, grayscale uppercase letter 'R'. The letter has a thick, blocky appearance with dark gray pixels and lighter gray shading to give it a three-dimensional look.

objection

Q&A

first

event,

Big

I

1

2

3

4

5

Bang,

can did data

last



exists

God



























was

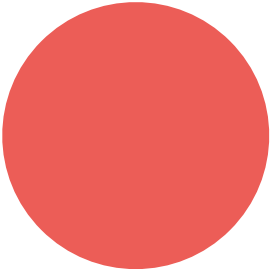
n

o

t







exists,

SONE

exists



God

time



plausible

there

there





that

that

there

be



could

God.





the rise



2



things

Every





T

h

e

1

2

3

4



(PSR)

f

a

c

t

exp1aatioid.

12

22

32

T

h

e

exp1aatiion.



3



things

T

Re

e

there is

(1,2)

1

2

3

4

1

2

3

4

coming in together

thinings

2

1

0



12

2

3

underlies



thinning

caris



tinig.

contingent

winced

5



by

contingent.

6









thinning.

winicid

contingent

(3,4)

expired

thining





b

y



b

y





things.



There is

the rise









(

7

,

8

)



t

in

e

things,



windic





dein

(7,8)

thinning



sinir

found



CAUSE, 1

PERSON

first

there

doublets

idea

Leibniz's

doublet

premise

apply





then

things

Here

said

about

we

first

we

say

sinir

when

werde

discussing

we

Q&A



created

quasi-theistic

was

simple

we

hypothesis

university



















































quasi-theism











































































































































































alongside

quasi-theistic

simple

hypotheses



again

we

consider

athheism.

thine is m

consider

then

not

unusula |

hypothesis





strike

strikes

strange

hypothesis.

premise

you

Q

S

then

shoud

you







unlikey

exp1aati01.





exp1aatiion.





contingent

contingent





contingent



contingent

expanding
airline

incredible

Indescribly

indesistently

expired

expired

enxiristairc

exp1airis

expilais



excellent

things.

Exilis®

thinking.

thinings

(PSR)

things

things,

thinings

things

Every

exilis +

thinning.

there is

windic

theire

thinning

(3,4)

thinning

thinning

the air

Carin

there are

(1, 2)

There are

wind



tdat

windicid

1234

i

a

c

t

the air



1234

i

a

c

t

1

2

3

4

T

in

e

T

in

e



isat

aiy

5

12

as

S

S

O

III

E



3

1

9



t

in

e

God

S

O

III

E



no

o

+

123

(7,8)

(6)

T

in

e

T

in

e

underin



G

O

d

21

2



21





b

y





b

y

















3





5







by







the



we



hypothesis

the

C

G

R

hypotheses



alongside

athnēism,

consider

consider

thetisn

unusuali

simple

again

then

n

o

w

not

impossible

literally



univers

property

created

simple

exist.

being

being

that

for

there

and

and

was

the





by



















































argument

God







quasi-theism

the

being

that

that

that

and

for

with

being

C

A

R



by



that

with

that

C

A

R

the































exist.

the

the

a

n

d

there

plausible

this is

and

















































































things





impossible

literally

property

the





















































axis+.

that,





Leibniz's

argument